MANUSCRIPT REVIEW REPORT

Valuing diversity: an undervalued mediator of intergroup contact

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ABOUT THIS REPORT

This report was generated by an AI-powered manuscript review skill for Claude Code. It combines LLM-based analysis with automated checks powered by the metacheck R package (DeBruine, 2024). Automated checks are marked with [metacheck] badges. All suggestions should be verified by the authors. **Note:** Some apparent errors may stem from PDF text extraction and should be verified against the source document.

OVERALL SUMMARY

This accepted manuscript presents two well-structured studies examining valuing diversity as a mediator of intergroup contact effects. The writing is generally clear and professional, with a logical structure and appropriate use of APA conventions. The main issues identified include inconsistent OSF data availability links across pages (with different view_only tokens), duplicate keywords on the title page, heading capitalization inconsistencies, a spelling error, and the use of 'marginally significant' language for a non-significant result. The manuscript includes appropriate compliance statements and commendable open science practices.

CRITICAL ISSUES	MAJOR ISSUES	MINOR ISSUES
1	4	8

Inconsistent OSF data availability links — Title Page / Data Availability (pp. 1–2)

Two different view_only tokens are provided for the OSF link on pages 1 and 2, creating confusion about which is the correct data repository link. Details in the corresponding section below.

LANGUAGE QUALITY

Overall language quality: A–

Key Strengths

- Clear articulation of research questions and hypotheses across both studies
- Effective integration of theoretical background from multiple research traditions (contact hypothesis, diversity beliefs, polyculturalism)
- Well-organized progression from Study 1 to Study 2, with clear rationale for the conceptual replication
- Appropriate hedging of claims given the cross-sectional design (e.g., 'consistent with a model,' 'suggest')
- Technical statistical language is precise and accessible

Areas for Improvement

- Minor heading capitalization inconsistencies should be resolved for a polished final version
- One instance of 'marginally significant' language warrants reconsideration
- A spelling error ('refering' instead of 'referring') on page 15 should be corrected

SECTION REVIEW

SECTION	STATUS	ISSUES
1. Title Clarity, length, accuracy	✓	0

SECTION	STATUS	ISSUES
2. Main Headings Hierarchy, consistency, formatting	×	3
3. Title Page Author details, affiliations, compliance statements	×	2
4. Abstract Structure, completeness, length	×	1
5. Structure Overall organization, section order	✓	0
6. Figures and Tables Captions, cross-references, formatting	×	1
7. Referencing APA format, DOIs, retraction checks	i	0
8. Language Grammar, spelling, style	×	3
9. Acronyms Definition on first use, consistency	✓	0
10. Funding & Compliance Ethics, COI, data availability, open science	×	2
11. Light Content Checks Causal language, limitations, sample description	×	1
12. Statistical Reporting APA format, statcheck, p-values	i	0

DETAILED RECOMMENDATIONS

1. Title

0 issues

The title 'Valuing diversity: an undervalued mediator of intergroup contact' is clear, descriptive, and appropriately concise (9 words). It effectively communicates the key variables and the manuscript's contribution. It avoids abbreviations and accurately reflects the content. The use of 'undervalued' adds a persuasive angle that is well-supported by the manuscript.

2. Main Headings

3 issues: 3 Minor

The manuscript uses a mix of sentence case and title case across headings. Most sub-headings use sentence case, but 'The Present Research' (p. 6) uses title case while nearby headings such as 'The importance of valuing diversity' and 'The promise of intergroup contact' use sentence case. Similarly, at the main heading level, 'General discussion' (p. 16) and 'Limitations and future directions' (p. 17) appear in sentence case while other main headings (Study 1, Study 2, Conclusion) use title case. Consistent capitalisation throughout same-level headings would improve polish.

Location: Section heading (p. 6) Minor

Original: The Present Research

Suggestion: The present research

Explanation: This heading uses title case ('Present Research') while other section headings at the same level use sentence case (e.g., 'The importance of valuing diversity,' 'The promise of intergroup contact'). Consider using sentence case for consistency.

Location: Section heading (p. 16) Minor

Original: General discussion

Suggestion: General Discussion

Explanation: If the manuscript adopts title case for main headings (as in 'Study 1,' 'Study 2,' 'Conclusion'), then 'General discussion' should be 'General Discussion.' Alternatively, the other main headings could be adjusted. The key is consistency across same-level headings.

Location: Section heading (p. 17) Minor

Original: Limitations and future directions

Suggestion: Limitations and Future Directions

Explanation: Same capitalisation inconsistency as the heading above. Consider making all same-level headings consistent in their use of title case or sentence case.

3. Title Page

2 issues: 1 Major 1 Minor

The title page includes all three authors with email addresses and numbered affiliations, a note about Lukas Wallrich's current affiliation at Birkbeck, word counts, table/figure counts, a data availability statement, a declaration of conflicting interests, a funding declaration, ethics approval, and acknowledgements. However, the keywords appear to be duplicated, and ORCID IDs and a CRediT author contribution statement are not included.

Duplicate keywords

Location: Title Page, Keywords (p. 1)

Major

> **Action: Remove duplicated keywords block.** The keywords 'intergroup contact, diversity beliefs, multiculturalism, prejudice, social integration' appear twice on page 1 — once after the affiliations and once near the bottom of the page, below the acknowledgements. Retain only one instance.

Explanation: The keywords list appears to be duplicated on the title page, likely due to a formatting error during manuscript preparation.

Location: Title Page, Author note (p. 1)

Minor

> **Original:** NB: Lukas Wallrich is now at the Department of Organisational Psychology, Birkbeck College, University of London

> **Action:** Consider reformatting this note without the 'NB:' prefix. Most journals use a standard **author note** format for present address information (e.g., 'Lukas Wallrich is now at the Department of Organisational Psychology, Birkbeck College, University of London').

Explanation: The 'NB:' prefix is somewhat informal for an academic manuscript. Consider following the target journal's style for present address notes.

4. Abstract

1 issue: 1 Minor

The abstract is well-structured and clearly states the research gap, methods (two studies, total N = 2,835), key findings (valuing diversity mediates the relationships of intergroup contact with prejudice, bystander intervention intentions, policy support, and approach intentions), and conclusion. At 110 words, it is on the short side — many journals prefer 150–300 words. The abstract appropriately avoids citations, abbreviations, and references to figures or tables.

Abstract length

Location: Abstract (p. 3)

Minor

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Action: Consider whether the abstract length (110 words) meets the
target journal's requirements. Many psychology journals require
150–250 words. If expansion is needed, consider briefly mentioning
the specific study contexts (UK student sample and German
probability sample) and the comparison with other mediators
(empathy, anxiety).
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Explanation: At 110 words, the abstract is concise but may be below minimum requirements for some journals. The European Journal of Social Psychology typically allows up to 200 words.

5. Structure

0 issues

The manuscript follows a clear and logical structure: Introduction (with thematic subsections), Study 1 (Method, Measures, Results, Discussion), Study 2 (Method, Measures, Results, Discussion), General Discussion (with Limitations and Future Directions subsection), Conclusion, References, Tables, and Figures. Methods sections appear before Results in both studies, and subsections are logically organised. The placement of tables and figures at the end follows standard manuscript submission formatting.

6. Figures and Tables

1 issue: 1 Minor

The manuscript includes 5 figures (Figures 1a–1d and Figure 2) and 5 tables (Tables 1–5). All are referenced in the text with placement markers, which is standard for submissions. Figure captions are descriptive and consistent; table captions are clear. The mediation model figures are well-designed with clear labelling of paths, standardised coefficients, and confidence intervals. One inconsistency in significance level notation across tables was identified.

Location: Tables 1 vs. 2 and 5 (pp. 24, 25, 28)

Minor

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Action: Table 1 uses significance markers '* p < .05,  p < .01, * p
< .001' while Tables 2 and 5 include an additional level '† p <
.1'. Consider using consistent significance level notation across
all tables — either include or omit the dagger (†) marker in all
tables.
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Explanation: Inconsistent use of significance markers across tables may confuse readers. If marginal significance is reported in some tables, the same convention should ideally be available in all correlation and path tables. Note that the use of the † marker is also related to the 'marginally significant' language issue flagged in Category 11.

7. Referencing

0 issues

The reference list contains approximately 71 genuine references, well-formatted in APA style with DOIs included for most journal articles. After verifying all GROBID-flagged cross-reference items against the PDF, no genuine cross-reference issues were found — all flagged items were parsing artifacts (secondary citations, page-specific references, confidence intervals misidentified as citations, or table notes misidentified as bibliography entries). The metacheck automated checks are detailed below.

Retraction & Integrity Check [metacheck]

Metacheck scanned 59 references with DOIs. No retracted references were found, and no references had PubPeer comments — a clean result. No citations to articles in the FLoRA replication database were found. Metacheck also identified 15 references without DOIs and found potential DOI matches for 6 of them; these suggestions are shown in the table below. Note that two of the suggested matches correspond to GROBID parsing artifacts (table notes incorrectly parsed as references) and should be disregarded. For books and software packages, DOIs may not be standard and authors should verify before adding.

DOI Suggestions [metacheck]

REFERENCE	SUGGESTED DOI	CONFIDENCE
Corrigan PW, Rowan D, Green A, Lundin R, River P, Uphoff-Wasowski K, White K, Kubiak MA (2002). "Challenging two mental illness stigmas: Personal responsibility and dangerousness." Schizophrenia Bulletin, 28(2), 293-309.	10.1093/oxfordjournals.schbul.a006939	✓
Johnston BM, Glasford DE (2018). "Intergroup contact and helping: How quality contact and empathy shape outgroup helping." Group Processes & Intergroup Relations, 21(8), 1185-1201.	10.1177/1368430217711770	✓
Jorgensen TD, Pornprasertmanit S, Schoemann AM, Rosseel Y (2019). "semTools: Useful tools for structural equation modeling."	10.32614/cran.package.semtools	✓
Oberski D (2014). "lavaan.survey: An R Package for Complex Survey Analysis of Structural Equation Models." Journal of Statistical Software, 57(1), 1-27.	10.18637/jss.v057.i01	i
Schlesinger AM (1998). The disuniting of America: Reflections on a multicultural society. WW Norton & Company.	10.4324/9780429501531-19	×
Vertovec S, Wessendorf S (2010). The multiculturalism backlash: European discourses, policies, and practices. Routledge.	10.4324/9780203867549	i

Confidence based on CrossRef match scores from metacheck.

8. Language

3 issues: 1 Major 2 Minor

The manuscript is well-written with clear, academic prose. The language predominantly uses British English (e.g., 'neighbourhoods' on pp. 13, 15; 'behaviour' in reference titles), though with one instance of American English spelling. Grammar, spelling, and punctuation are generally excellent, with one spelling error and one instance of ambiguous phrasing identified.

Location: Discussion, Study 2 (p. 15) Major

> **Original:** the results should be interpreted as refering to approach towards such immigrants

> **Suggestion:** the results should be interpreted as **referring** to approach towards such immigrants

Explanation: 'Refering' is a spelling error; the correct spelling is 'referring' (double 'r').

British/American English inconsistency

Location: Introduction (p. 5) Minor

> **Original:** valuing ethnically diverse neighborhoods was one of the strongest predictors of prejudice

> **Suggestion:** valuing ethnically diverse **neighbourhoods** was one of the strongest predictors of prejudice

Explanation: The manuscript uses 'neighbourhoods' elsewhere (pp. 13, 15), suggesting British English is the intended variety. This instance uses the American spelling 'neighborhoods.' Consider using 'neighbourhoods' for consistency.

Ambiguous direction of effect

Location: Introduction (p. 5)

Minor

> **Original:** Relatedly, Dirksmeier (2014) showed that valuing ethnically diverse neighborhoods was one of the strongest predictors of prejudice in a representative German sample.

> **Suggestion:** Relatedly, Dirksmeier (2014) showed that valuing ethnically diverse neighbourhoods was one of the strongest predictors of **lower** prejudice in a representative German sample.

Explanation: As written, the sentence could be interpreted as meaning that valuing diverse neighbourhoods predicts more prejudice. Adding 'lower' or 'reduced' clarifies the direction of the association.

9. Acronyms

0 issues

Acronyms are used sparingly and defined on first use. ALLBUS is defined on page 11 as 'German General Social Survey (ALLBUS),' and ISCED is referenced on page 13 in context. The abbreviation 'Val. diversity' is explained in table notes. Standard statistical abbreviations (M, SD, CI, p, r, α) are used without explicit definition, which is appropriate for the target audience. No acronym issues were found.

10. Funding & Compliance

2 issues: 1 Critical 1 Major

The manuscript includes all key compliance statements on the title page: a conflict of interest declaration, a funding declaration, ethics approval (Goldsmiths' Psychology Departmental Research Ethics Committee, following APA and BPS guidelines), and acknowledgements. A data availability statement with an OSF link is provided. However, two different view_only tokens appear across the manuscript, creating a critical inconsistency. No preregistration is mentioned, and ORCID IDs and a CRediT author contribution statement are absent.

Inconsistent OSF data availability links

Location: Data availability statement (pp. 1–2)

Critical

> **Action: Resolve the inconsistent OSF view_only tokens.** Page 1 provides the link https://osf.io/sbpxj/?view_only=7d652e89096d4c39b8ca5de893ac384a, while page 2 (and later pp. 7, 11) uses https://osf.io/sbpxj/?view_only=d1d6d70ce50d4d95a415f5fae756d985. These are different tokens and may provide access to different content or have different expiry dates. **Verify which token is correct and use a single consistent link throughout the manuscript.**

Explanation: Having two different view_only tokens for the same OSF repository creates confusion. Reviewers and readers may access different content depending on which link they follow, or one link may no longer work.

Missing ORCID IDs and CRediT statement

Location: Title page (p. 1)

Major

> **Action:** Consider adding **ORCID IDs** for all authors and a **CRediT author contribution statement,** as many journals now require or strongly encourage these.

Explanation: ORCID IDs and CRediT statements are increasingly required or recommended by journals. Adding them proactively strengthens the manuscript's compliance profile.

Open Science Practices [metacheck]

Metacheck confirmed commendable open science practices: both data and analysis code are openly shared via OSF, and a conflict of interest statement is present. Four OSF links were found in the manuscript, but no formal preregistration was detected among them — authors may wish to consider preregistering future follow-up studies. Metacheck flagged that no funding statement was detected; however, this appears to be a parsing error, as the funding declaration ('There is no funding to declare') is clearly present on page 1.

11. Light Content Checks

1 issue: 1 Major

The manuscript presents a well-designed pair of complementary studies. Study 1 uses a UK student sample with multiple outcome measures, while Study 2 uses a representative German population sample with behavioural intention measures and additional control variables. The limitations section is thorough and transparent. Metacheck flagged 8 instances of potential causal language in the abstract, but after evaluation, all are standard mediation terminology ('predict,' 'mediates,' 'offer a lever') rather than genuine causal overclaims — the authors explicitly acknowledge in the Limitations section that cross-sectional analyses cannot establish causality. One instance of 'marginally significant' language warrants reconsideration (see also Category 12).

Marginal significance language

Location: Results, Study 1 (p. 9)

Major

> **Original:** that difference was largest and marginally significant in the case of affective prejudice

> **Suggestion:** that difference was largest, **though not statistically significant,** in the case of affective prejudice

Explanation: The use of 'marginally significant' language is discouraged in contemporary quantitative psychology. The confidence interval reported (Δr = .20, 95% CI [.00, .40]) includes zero at its lower bound, indicating the difference is not statistically significant at the .05 level. Consider describing the result as non-significant while noting the effect size and confidence interval. This is consistent with the dagger (†) significance marker issue noted in Category 6 (Tables).

Observations

> **Introduction and background:** The introduction effectively synthesises literature from diversity beliefs, intergroup contact theory, and mediation research. The progression from establishing the importance of valuing diversity, through the contact hypothesis, to the gap in research linking these two literatures is clear and compelling. The rationale for the specific hypotheses is well-grounded in theory.

Limitations discussion: The limitations section is commendably thorough, addressing: (1) the focus on majority-group perspectives only, (2) the cross-sectional design limiting causal inference, (3) the use of behavioural intentions rather than actual behaviours, and (4) the bidirectional relationship between valuing diversity and contact. The authors appropriately call for experimental and longitudinal follow-up research.

Sample description: Both samples are well-described. Study 1 provides details on demographics (N = 217, 89% female, ages 18–45), recruitment across five universities with varying diversity contexts, and data collection methods. Study 2 describes the ALLBUS sampling procedure, exclusion criteria, and resulting sample characteristics (N = 2,618, 49.3% female, mean age 50.8). The gender imbalance in Study 1 is not explicitly discussed as a limitation — this could be briefly noted, though it is typical of psychology student samples.

Statistical methods and effect sizes: The analytical approaches are appropriate: SEM with full-information maximum likelihood for Study 1, and SEM with multiple imputation via mice and lavaan.survey for Study 2 (accounting for complex survey design). Bootstrapped and Monte Carlo confidence intervals for indirect effects are reported. Effect sizes are presented throughout via standardised coefficients and confidence intervals. The authors appropriately note that indirect effects in Study 2 are small and contextualise this with reference to Greenwald et al. (2015) on the societal implications of small effects.

Data and code availability: Data for Study 1 and analysis code for both studies are shared via OSF, which is commendable. Study 2 uses the ALLBUS dataset, for which data access instructions are provided. This supports reproducibility, though the inconsistent OSF links need to be resolved (see Category 10, Funding & Compliance).

12. Statistical Reporting

0 issues

No statistical reporting errors were identified. Metacheck's statcheck module did not detect any APA-formatted test statistics to verify, as the manuscript primarily reports standardised path coefficients, correlation coefficients, and confidence intervals in tables and figures rather than in-text test statistics (e.g., F, t, chi-square). This is

appropriate and expected for SEM-based analyses. The three substantive p-values in the body text ($p < .001$ in Study 2 results) are used appropriately alongside confidence intervals.

Statcheck [metacheck]

No APA-formatted test statistics (e.g., t, F, chi-square) were detected in the manuscript text, so statcheck could not run any consistency checks. This is expected given the SEM-based analytical approach, where results are primarily communicated via standardised coefficients and confidence intervals in tables and figures.

P-values & Marginal Significance [metacheck]

Metacheck detected 12 p-values in the manuscript. Most appear in table notes as significance level legends (e.g., '† $p < .1$, * $p < .05$, **$p < .01$,** * $p < .001$'), rather than as reported test results. Metacheck also flagged one instance of marginal significance language, which corresponds to the 'marginally significant' phrasing addressed in Category 11 above. The use of the † $p < .1$ threshold in some tables (but not all) is flagged as an inconsistency in Category 6.